





SAN FRANCISCO

Uncorked and Unbound

Experience the rolling hills and valleys of California's most celebrated wine region from a hot air balloon or atop a vintage train. Gliding slowly above sun-kissed Napa at 3,000 feet for a birds-eye-view of dawn breaking on the valley, is an unforgettable experience. Naturally, the ride ends with a glorious Champagne toast.

For a deep dive into the region's most iconic wineries, book the six-hour Legacy Experience of the Napa Valley Wine Train that takes you to its most iconic wineries in plush, open-air cars. See Napa's oldest winery, Charles Krug and pick up a bottle of Cabernet Sauvignon or Madeira at V. Sattui, famed for its award-winning wines. At Robert Mondavi, which has reopened after a three-year makeover, lounge in new, glass-walled open-air tasting rooms. This is the winery which put Napa wines on the global map; a gourmet four-course meal is just par for the course.

https://www.visitnapavalley.com/ and https://www.winetrain.com/
Wine train cost US$1,441 for two (approx. ₹1.3 lakh)



NEW YORK

Triumph of Taste

If you are craving a slice of home after the match frenzy, pick one of these culinary gems that have quietly, reimagined defined Indian cuisine in the city. Semma, a one Michelin star South Indian restaurant in Manhattan, broke all records when it topped The New York Times annual list of the city's 100 best restaurants last year—no small feat in a city of more than 20,000 dining spots.

Serpentine queues outside chef Vikas Khanna's storied Bungalow, since the day it opened, still remains still one of the hardest reservations to procure. An homage to his roots and heritage, dining here has often been equated with a soulful homecoming. Getting a table at Ambassadors Clubhouse from London, which opened in February this year, is also a bit of a struggle. Its rich, bold Punjabi flavours, especially Original BBQ Butter Chicken Chops, have delighted many palates. But will you get that table? Remember, 'fastest finger first'.

https://www.semma.nyc/; https://www.bungalowny.com/; https://ambassadorsclubhouse.com/newyork/
Meal for two at these is upwards of US$150 (approx. ₹14,000)